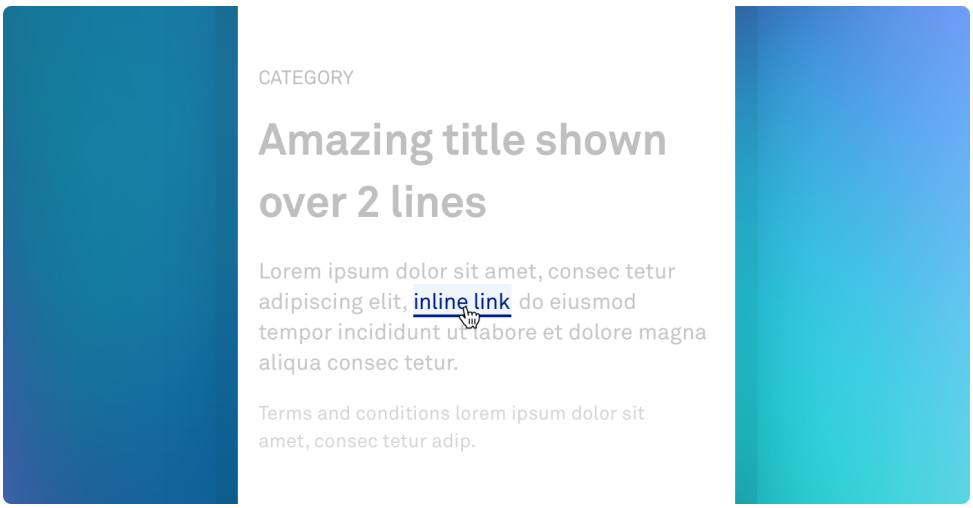
*Need help? Self-Service || Yammer || **No new spaces from Nov-23rd***

Inline Link

Created by Alex Dewez-Lopez, last modified by Tony Wang yesterday at 4:38 PM



Version

1

Availability

Web

On This Page

- Rationale
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Inline Links allow the user to navigate between web pages. They are intended to be used "inline" meaning they sit within the flow of a paragraph or sentence.

Useful Docs

- Writing Link Text
- Action Button or Inline Link?

Specs

- Inline Link (Web)

UI Playground

- Web Playground
- React Playground

Rationale

- Custom Underline Style
  Understand why we created our own custom underlines for our Inline Links pattern.
- The importance of the visited state's colour
  Nielsen Norman Group has a great analysis on why purple links are important for user navigation.

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Usage (For Designers)

An Inline Link can be used:

- to navigate to other web pages that contain more specific and detailed contents
- to reduce clutter by linking to supporting content
- to link to another section of the current page (also known as anchors)
- within a sentence or paragraph
- in a bullet list or a numbered list

Usage (For Developers)

View Inline Links Developer Documentation →

What is considered an Inline Link?

Scope	UI Preview
✅	Paragraph or sentence Please read the Terms & Conditions before submitting the form.

Scope	UI Preview
✅	Bullet list • Google • Facebook • Linked In • Telstra • Twitter
✅	Numbered list 1. Read the guidelines instructions 2. Fill out the form 3. Send to processing department
❌	Footer Contact us Support Find a store Check for outages Troubleshoot an issue Consumer advice Financial hardship
❌	Breadcrumbs Enterprise > News & Research > Enterprise Security > En
❌	Header links Personal Business Enterprise
❌	Link lists Plans and devices Internet Apps and services Internet of Things Quick links Mobiles on a plan SIM only plans Office phone plans Tablets on a plan
❌	More with your service Recent charges Data usage Add-ons
❌	Footer social links Facebook Twitter Instagram

Anatomy

Best Practices

UX / VD

- **Links should make sense on their own.**
  Users may navigate from link to link on a webpage using keyboard or screen reader. Each link text should describe its destination, such as page title or document title; the user should not have to read surrounding text to understand context. Learn how to write link text.

✅ Do.	❌ Don't.
Please read the Terms & Conditions before submitting the form. This is clear by reading link alone. '*Terms & Conditions*' tells the user what the link is pointing to.	Click here to read the Terms & Conditions before submitting the form. *Click here*' is meaningless. It's not clear to the user without reading the surrounding content. (Also avoid terms such as, *Read more*, *see info*, *retry*, *click for details*, or *link to [page]*.)

- **Don't use in a heading.**
  Headings describe the content and shouldn't have a link within them.

❌ Don't.
Heading title

- **Use within a paragraph**
  Using Inline Links within a paragraph offers additional information about a topic within the context of the paragraph. If the content calls for the user to perform an action, the correct pattern to use is Action Button. To understand this better, see When to Use Action Button or Inline Link.

✅ Do.	❌ Don't.
inline link	Perform an action

- **Document links should include file type and file size.**
  If an inline link downloads or opens a file (e.g. PDF or CSV), we recommended to include its file type and size.

✅ Do.	✋ Avoid.
Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur elit Sign up form (PDF, 3MB) tempor et incididunt aliqua.	Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur elit Sign up form tempor et incididunt magna aliqua.

- **Avoid using the same link text repeatedly on the same page**
  Having generic link text like "read more" repeated on a page–which link to different destinations–is difficult for keyboard users and screen readers to differentiate between the links.
- **Don't modify the colour of Inline Links**
  They're designed to follow Able's interactive colour pattern, providing a consistent interaction experience for our users.
- **Don't modify Inline Link's visited behaviour.**
  Inline Links have an important interaction state: Visited. It provides a visual clue to where users have already been on your website. It reduces navigation confusion, without it users may unintentionally revisit the same pages repeatedly.

Developers

- **Links should inherit Text Styles from their parent.**
  Inline Links should always inherit the `font-family`, `font-size`, `line-height` and `letter-spacing` from its parent element.
- **Use a the background-color parameter when Inline Links are placed on a coloured background.**
  Inline Links will sometimes be placed on coloured backgrounds, this will give the Inline Links content a glow effect which must be avoided. Use the `able-inline-links($background-colour)` mixin which allows you to pass the background colour as a parameter, removing the glow effect.
- **If there is punctuation immediately before or after a link, don't include the punctuation in the link**.

✅ Do.	❌ Dont.
Lorem ipsuma, see Privacy statement.	Lorem ipsuma, see Privacy statement.

- **Don't change or override the visited link's colour.**
  Visited link provides a visual clue as to where users have already been on your website. It reduces navigation confusion, without it users may unintentionally revisit the same pages repeatedly.

Writing Link Text

There are three key rules to keep in mind when writing quality link text. Link text should be:

1. **Short** enough to quickly read
2. **Descriptive** enough to know where it will take you
3. In **context** with the surrounding text and the destination webpage.

> **Tip**
> When judging the quality of a link, consider *only the link text* for the **short** and **descriptive** rules. For the **context** rule, consider the *surrounding content* and the *link destination*.

To understand this better, have a look at our examples for writing link text.

Interaction States

There are 5 unique states in Inline Link.

For more details on the different interaction states, see Interaction States.

Normal **Hover** **Pressed** **Keyboard Focused** **Visited**

A visited state indicates an element has been visited (c on) by the user previously.

Interactions

Inline Links can be activated on mouse click or keyboard Enter / Return key.

Accessibility Considerations

Inline Links are designed to meet the WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria outlined below. All requirements should be considered and understood when using the pattern. Requirements marked with ⚠️ can only be met once the pattern is in use.

Design

- 1.4.1 Use of Color (A) - Colour alone is not used as the only visual cue to convey information.
  An underline is used to meet this requirement.
- 1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum) (AA)
  The contrast between the link text and the background colour meets a minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio.
- 2.4.7 Focus Visible (AA)
  All inline links have a visible focus state. We have defined a strong focus state which also includes the hover state.

Development

- 1.4.4 Resize text (AA) - When resized to 200%, the link text is not truncated.
  Inline Links are inline so they naturally resize with the parent element.
- 1.4.10 Reflow (AA) - When scaled to 400%, there is no loss of content or functionality.
  Inline Links are inline so they naturally scale with the parent element.
- 1.4.12 Text-Spacing (AA) - Text meets minimum the text style requirements.
  Inline Links take the parent's element Text Style which already pass this requirement.
- 2.1.1 Keyboard (A) - Link element is accessible by keyboard.
  All links are focusable using keyboard by default.

Content

- 2.4.4 Link Purpose (A) - the content of the link should help user understand the purpose of the link.
  ⚠️ This requirement must be met by a content specialist or producer when authoring.

Keyboard

Users must be able to navigate to and select each link using the keyboard alone. In most browsers, the Tab key allows users to jump from link to link, and the Enter key allows users to select a link.

Screen Reader

- Screen readers generally inform users that a piece of text (or a graphic) is a link
- Most screen readers say "link" before each link. For example, a "products" link would be read as "link products" by JAWS. As such links do not need to include "link" in the link text, because all users already know that the link is a link.
- Screen reader users often navigate from link to link, skipping the text in between.
- Links should make sense out of context. Phrases such as "click here", "more", "click for details", "retry" and so on are ambiguous when read out of context.

Related Patterns

- Action Button
- Breadcrumb
- Link List

No labels

Atlassian